

USB Flash Drive And Viruses!

Q My name is Kharthigeyan. I use Windows XP SP3. Recently I accessed a pen drive without scanning it with my antivirus. My system was immediately infected by a virus. I soon found out that in the Explorer Folder Options, the Show Hidden Files radio button and Hide protected operating system files checkboxes stopped functioning. All the other Windows applications – Task Manager, gpedit.msc, regedit and command prompt still work properly. My system configuration is Windows XP SP3, 1 GB RAM, 1.83 GHz processor 80 GB Hard Disk. Please suggest some programs and tips that can help me to avoid these kinds of problems in future.

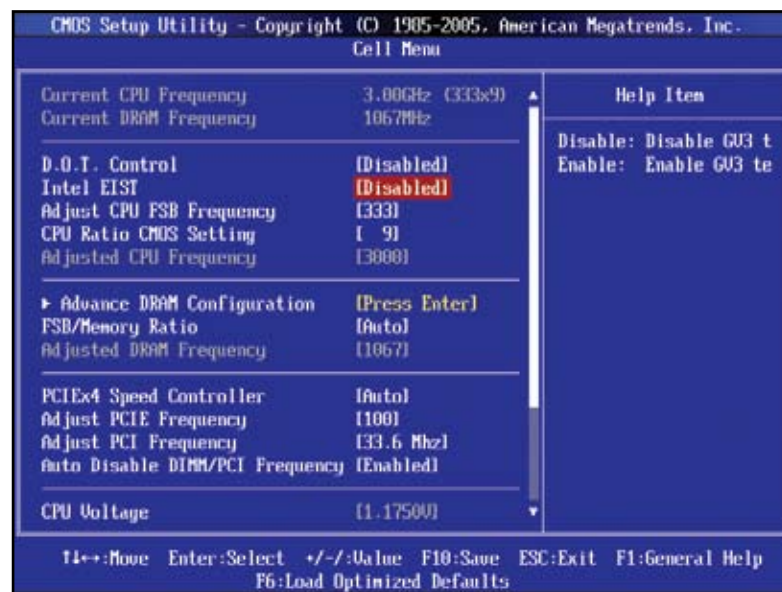
Kharthigeyan



A Antivirus software isn't foolproof and alone cannot stop viruses and worms. There are a few things that can be done by the user. Avoid downloading files from unknown suspicious sites. Auto-running flash drives is one of the quickest way to activate a virus from an infected flash drive. Close the Autorun window when you are faced with one. Instead, open the flash drive directly by accessing its drive letter from the Start > Run window or through Windows Explorer. Placing a write-protected folder named AUTORUN.INF in your flash drive can also help prevent some of the usual flash drive infecting viruses from re-entering your drive. Keeping the antivirus updated at all times can also help prevent viruses from entering your system.

Incorrect Processor Speed Causes Problems With Games And Software

Q I have an Intel Core 2 Duo E6300 core (1.86 GHz) processor. My processor speed shows up as 1.40 GHz instead of 1.83 GHz. Due to this, I am unable to run the game Need for Speed Carbon. My CPU doesn't even complete the minimum requirements for MS Visual Studio 2008 Express Edition. Please help me with my problem.



A Almost all motherboards and processors come with features to automatically under-clock the processor to save power and to help maintain lower temperatures when the total power of the processor is not required. This throttling can be disabled from the BIOS. Look for a feature called Intel SpeedStep or EIST. Disable this and the processor should run at its default speeds. The games and other software should install without any problems.

Flash Drive Loses Data

Q I have had a 1 GB Amkette Ergo S Series USB device pen drive since October 2006 which I've been using regularly. For sometime, I have been facing a problem with this pen drive. Whenever I insert it into the USB port, I am told that the drives requires formatting. When I format it and copy data onto the pen drive, the data gets transferred into the drive successfully. When I eject it from the port and re-insert it, then the formatting error pops up again and I lose all my copied data. My computer configuration is Intel D101GGC motherboard Intel Pentium 4 processor - 20 GHz Symtronix 512 MB RAM 80 GB Seagate 7200 rpm HDD Happy Deepawali to you and your team

Ritesh Kumar

A The problem you are facing lies with the pen drive. Try doing a standard format instead of a Quick Format. You can try the flash drive on another computer to see if the problem occurs there. If you have been using your flash drive a lot, then there is a good chance that it is corrupted. Although repair or replacement seems impossible now, the good news is that prices for USB flash drives have crashed. A 4 GB pen drive for example can be bought for as little as Rs= 500.

Odd regsvr.exe Error On Startup..

Q I went through your September issue of Digit magazine. I'm very eager to learn what's causing this problem I have. After logging in to my Windows user account, in the desktop the following message box appears - "Windows cannot find regsvr.exe. Make sure you typed the name correctly and then try again. To search for a file click start button and then click start." When I search for the

file, it seems there is no such file is available in the system but regsvr32.exe is available My system configuration is: Intel Celeron CPU 1.70 GHz, 352 MB RAM Microsoft Windows XP Professional, Service Pack 2

K.R.Dhananjeyan

A You have a virus on your computer. You will also find files AUTORUN.INF in the root of all partitions and drives. Folders will also be visible as executable files. The virus can also be removed manually by deleting the .INF files from the roots of the partitions and drives. Entries to the virus will also be removed from the Windows Registry. The executable files showing up with folder names will also have to be removed. The simplest way would be to install an antivirus such as Trend Micro Antivirus to clean out the virus.

Do All Processors Support 64-bit Processing?

Q Hi, I am a regular reader of Digit magazine and would like to ask you a very important set of questions.

1. In every issue you recommend a PC configuration for hardcore gamers or for 3D rendering purposes, like Core 2 Duo (3.0 GHz) or he Quad Core (2.4 GHz). Are these two processors 32-bit or 64-bit?
2. I want a configuration for 3D rendering and gaming purposes. Also suggest whether to use 32- or 64-bit processors and operating system. Budget is no problem, but it should be good in respect of performance and durability.

Kamlesh

A All of the processors today are 64-bit. Intel processors are generally denoted as EM64T. Both the Core 2 Duo and the Core 2 Quad are 64-bit processors. For 3D rendering purposes, go for a quad core processor. For gaming, a higher core speed is more important than the number of cores.

A Q6600 is a really inexpensive processor these days and the Core 2 Duo E8400 or the E8500 are good dual-core processors to go for. 64-bit operating systems and 64-bit applications will be a little faster than 32-bit. The complete 4 GB of RAM will only be used on 64-bit operating systems.

The ASUS P5Q-E motherboard is a great Intel P45 based motherboard for most users. For games, a GeForce 9800GTX from ZOTAC will make good sense. The Palit Radeon 4850 card is also a good option in the same price bracket. A WD 6400AAKS 640 GB hard drive will go well with your configuration.



Is Changing Application Priority In Task Manager Harmful?

Q When looking at the Windows Task Manager, in the process tab there is a column for Image Name. When I right-click on this column, I get the option of setting a priority. Is it okay to change the priority to High, Low or Medium depending upon the application you are working on or will it corrupt my system? In case I'm using an application and at the same time there are other applications like download managers and antivirus, all running in the background. Can I set the Priority to high to the application I am currently working on? Will it hinder the working of the computer?

A It will not hinder the performance of your computer. You can set a high priority to any application you wish.

Aditya (TECH QNA Expert)

Can Files In The System Recovery Folder Be Viruses?

Q My antivirus software recently scanned my computer and I got a pop-up warning saying that it had found a virus. I am not completely sure if it is a virus. Moreover, the antivirus did not mention what type of virus it is. This is the message it showed me:

New! Full Featured ThinClient System
Highly Efficient ThinClient Embedded OS

Enjoy Embedded ThinClient OS
- Linux / WinXP / WinCE

Server Support
- RDP 4.0, RDP 5.x, RDP 6.x, Citrix, X11, Tarentella, NX, REXEC, VNC Client, Full Screen DOS, Novell DOS

Local Application
- Open Office Suite, Email Client (Thunderbird), Web Browser (Firefox), Media Player (Audio / Video), PDF Reader, Messengers, Skype.

Enjay Network Solutions web : www.enjayworld.com | email : info@enjayworld.com
Phone : 0260-3251732, 3241732, 3203400, 2785124 | 09898007650, 09377107650